approaches and liked to draw in young people. He had the wisdom and judgement which enabled him to realise not only if something was wel done, but also when it was time to stop. In my opinion, he was an ideal experimenter and innovator. When there were alternative courses of action before us, whose outcome was difficult to predict, or to reconcile varying perspectives, Prof. Sarabhai would resort to experimentation to resolve the issue. This was precisely the situation at INCOSPAR in 1963. A bunch of young, inexperienced, but nevertheless energetic and enthusiastic persons were given the task of fleshing out the spirit of selfreliance in the field of science and technology in general, and of space research in particular. It was a great example of leadership by trust.

The rocket launch site later blossomed into the Thumba Equatorial Rocket Launch Station (TERLS). TERLS was established through active col aboration with France, USA and USSR. The leader of the Indian space programme—Prof. Vikram Sarabhai—had comprehended the ful implications of the chal enge and had not balked at taking it on. Right from the day INCOSPAR was formed, he was aware of the need to organize an integrated national space